rate or stagnate in the next six months. There is also a continuing perception that the Modi government favours big business and neglects small entrepreneurs and farmers.

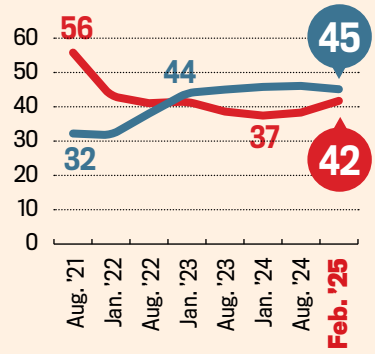
However, in a strange paradox, despite the economic woes, a majority trusts the Modi government to handle the economy. Respondents are also appreciative of the budget, especially its focus on growth and agriculture, besides the income tax concessions to the middle class, though a fourth beg to differ. The imperatives for Modi 3.0, therefore, are clear—hard focus on economic growth rather than dissipate energies elsewhere. There is concern over the focus on temple-mosques disputes and the deterioration of communal relations, for which the BJP and RSS are seen as responsible.

Anxieties over such as women's safety and a sense of democracy being in danger are other indications of that unease. There is disapproval over the perceived misuse of central investigating agencies like the Enforcement Directorate for political purposes and the deterioration of judicial independence under Modi rule. There is endorsement for enforcing a uniform civil code as well as for the abolition of Article 370, but a majority want statehood restored in Jammu and Kashmir.

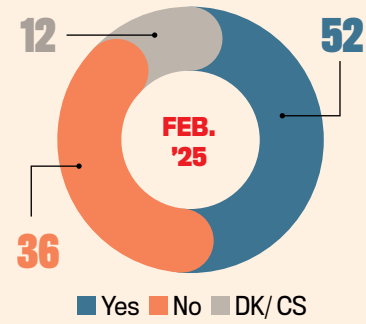
On foreign policy, while Modi gets a thumbs up, a majority believe that relations with neighbours have plummeted, and that India should resume peace talks with Pakistan and restart cultural exchanges. With China, given the thaw in relations, the view is to proceed with diplomatic dialogue and enhance trade relations but ensure that border security is strengthened. Surprisingly, a majority believe the Trump presidency to be good for India despite the brouhaha over deportations and tariffs.

Regarding the INDIA bloc, their demand for a national caste census gets a big thumbs up, with 69 per cent endorsing it. Despite the setbacks in the assembly polls, more than two-thirds believe INDIA should continue as they want a strong opposition. And whatever

Q. Do you think the BJP government misuses central investigating agencies like the ED, CBI and the I-T department more than other governments?

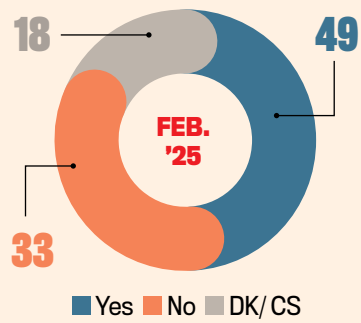


Q. Now that assembly polls have been held in J&K, should the Union government restore statehood?



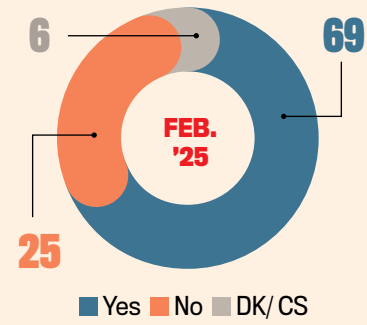
A majority backs the restoration of statehood in Jammu & Kashmir

Q. Do you think the Modi government is supporting the Adani Group amid allegations of bribery by a US court?



Nearly half the respondents believe the Centre is backing the Adani Group

Q. Do you support the government's legislation proposing to take back land owned by Waqf boards across the country?



Just one-fourth of the respondents are against the new Waqf legislation

All figures in % and rounded off

The perception that the BJP government misuses central agencies like the ED, CBI and the I-T department more than other governments in the past persists